UseThisSI

The Builder's 5-Minute AI Stack Kit

Pick the right AI tool for any job in 5 minutes. Real prices, checked every week. Free.

October 2026 edition · 10 jobs · 74 tools · prices checked Oct 18 to Oct 20, 2026

- Best tool for each job, with price and free tier
- 4 starter stacks under $50/mo
- The Skip List
- The $0 Stack: every job on free tiers
- First-hour quickstarts
- Our 24-hour wrong-price guarantee

www.usethissi.com

Start here How to use this kit in 5 minutes

1. **Find your job** on the next pages (building an app, writing, research, video, voice and more). Use the **Top Pick** unless you have a reason not to.
2. **Check the free tier** and the date we last checked the price. If you'd rather not pay yet, jump to **The $0 Stack**.
3. **Got a budget and a role, not a job list?** Grab one of the **4 starter stacks**, each under $50 a month.
4. **Do the first-hour quickstart** for your pick so you get a real result in your first session.

How we pick and check

- One Top Pick per job, chosen for fit for busy builders, not for who pays us.
- Every price comes from the vendor's own pricing page, with the date we checked it. If we couldn't verify a price, we say so instead of guessing.
- 74 of 74 tools were checked in the last 30 days. Prices change, so confirm on the vendor's site before you buy.
- Some links on our site are affiliate links. They're always labeled and never change our picks.

Our guarantee: wrong price, fixed in 24 hours

Found a price or free tier in this kit that's wrong? Reply to any UseThisSI email or write to info@usethissi.com. We'll fix it on the site within 24 hours and thank you in the brief.

Every weekday brief reads in 5 minutes or less. One-click unsubscribe, any time.

Best tool for each job Jobs 1-3 of 10

01 VIBE-CODE AN APP OR LANDING PAGE

Lovable TOP PICK

Chat-to-full-stack app with hosting; easiest on-ramp.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$25/mo Pro ($21/mo billed annually)	Yes (5 build credits/day)	Oct 19, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
Bolt.new	Fast browser app builder, hosting included	$25/mo Pro ($18/mo billed annually)	Oct 20, 2026
v0 by Vercel	Best React UI, deploys to Vercel	$30/user/mo Plus	Oct 20, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/vibe-code-an-app-or-landing-page/

02 AI CODING ASSISTANT

Cursor TOP PICK

Leading AI IDE with cloud agents.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$8/mo Plus (Grok models only); $30/mo Premium	Yes (limited)	Oct 19, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
Claude Code	Terminal coding agent	$17/mo annual, $20 monthly via Claude Pro	Oct 18, 2026
GitHub Copilot	Works in your existing editor	$10/mo Pro	Oct 20, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/ai-coding-assistant/

03 SET UP OR RUN AI AGENTS

n8n TOP PICK

Open-source agent and workflow builder.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
€20/mo Starter, billed annually	Yes (self-host Community Edition); Cloud free trial	Oct 20, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
Lindy	No-code personal and business agents	$29.99/user/mo Team (3,000 credits)	Oct 20, 2026
Manus	General autonomous agent	$20/mo Pro (4,000 credits; 17% off billed annually)	Oct 20, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/set-up-or-run-ai-agents/

Best tool for each job Jobs 4-6 of 10

04 AUTOMATE WORKFLOWS

Make TOP PICK

Visual automation at less than half Zapier's entry price.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$9/mo Core billed annually (10,000 credits)	Yes (1,000 credits/mo)	Oct 18, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
Zapier	Largest integration catalog	$19.99/mo Professional (starting price)	Oct 20, 2026
Gumloop	AI-native automation	$37/mo Pro	Oct 18, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/automate-workflows/

05 MAKE GAME ART AND SPRITES

Scenario TOP PICK

Style-trained, consistent game assets.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$15/mo Starter (monthly; annual saves 33%)	Yes (50 credits/day; personal use only)	Oct 18, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
PixelLab	Pixel-art sprites and animation	$12/mo Tier 1 Pixel Apprentice	Oct 18, 2026
Midjourney	Top-tier concept art	$10/mo Basic ($8/mo billed annually)	Oct 18, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/make-game-art-and-sprites/

06 GENERATE MUSIC AND SFX

Suno TOP PICK

Best song gen with commercial rights on Pro.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$8/mo Pro billed yearly, $10 monthly	Yes (50 credits/day, no commercial use)	Oct 18, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
ElevenLabs Music and SFX	SFX and music on the TTS plan	$6/mo Starter (music commercial use; $1 promo ended)	Oct 19, 2026
Udio	High-fidelity songs (downloads disabled)	$8/mo Standard billed annually, $10 monthly	Oct 18, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/generate-music-and-sfx/

Best tool for each job Jobs 7-8 of 10

07 EDIT AND GENERATE VIDEO

Runway TOP PICK

Pro-grade generative video.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$12/mo Standard billed annually, $15 monthly	Yes (125 one-time credits)	Oct 18, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
Descript	Edit video by editing text	$16/mo Hobbyist annual, $24 monthly	Oct 18, 2026
CapCut	Free short-form editor	$19.99/mo (US, monthly; yearly up to 30% off)	Oct 18, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/edit-and-generate-video/

08 WRITE CONTENT

Claude TOP PICK

Best long-form writing voice.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$17/mo Pro annual, $20 monthly	Yes	Oct 18, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
ChatGPT	All-rounder; GPT-6 on all tiers	$20/mo Plus (monthly only)	Oct 18, 2026
Jasper	Brand-voice marketing copy	$59/mo Pro annual, $69 monthly	Oct 18, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/write-content/

Best tool for each job Jobs 9-10 of 10

RESEARCH

09 Perplexity TOP PICK

Fast cited answers.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$17/mo Pro billed annually	Yes	Oct 18, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
Gemini (Deep Research)	Deep research; Gemini 4 Argon on Pro/Ultra	$4.99/mo Google AI Plus; $19.99/mo AI Pro	Oct 18, 2026
NotebookLM	Grounded in your own sources (now also branded Gemini Notebook)	$4.99/mo via Google AI Plus	Oct 18, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/research/

VOICE AND TTS

10 ElevenLabs TOP PICK

Most realistic voices.

STARTS AT	FREE TIER	CHECKED
$6/mo Starter (annual ~$5; $1 first-month promo ended Oct 18)	Yes (10k credits)	Oct 19, 2026

THE BENCH	WHY	STARTS AT	CHECKED
Cartesia	Low-latency voice for agents	$5/mo Pro	Oct 18, 2026
Murf AI	Studio voiceovers	API from $0.03 per 1,000 chars (Studio TTS)	Oct 18, 2026

www.usethissi.com/use-cases/voice-and-tts/

The $0 Stack

Every job on free tiers only

You can do all 10 jobs without paying anything. These are the best free options we could verify, with the real limits. Free tiers are for trying and light use; check the limits before you build a business on one.

JOB	USE THIS FREE	FREE TIER, AS LISTED	CHECKED
Vibe-code an app or landing page	Lovable	Yes (5 build credits/day)	Oct 19, 2026
AI coding assistant	Cursor	Yes (limited)	Oct 19, 2026
Set up or run AI agents	n8n	Yes (self-host Community Edition); Cloud free trial	Oct 20, 2026
Automate workflows	Make	Yes (1,000 credits/mo)	Oct 18, 2026
Make game art and sprites	Scenario	Yes (50 credits/day; personal use only)	Oct 18, 2026
Generate music and SFX	Suno	Yes (50 credits/day, no commercial use)	Oct 18, 2026
Edit and generate video	Runway	Yes (125 one-time credits)	Oct 18, 2026
Write content	Claude	Yes	Oct 18, 2026
Research	Perplexity	Yes	Oct 18, 2026
Voice and TTS	ElevenLabs	Yes (10k credits)	Oct 19, 2026

59 of 74 tools in our directory have a free tier we verified in the last 30 days.

4 starter stacks under $50/mo

Pick your role, not a tool

Each stack covers a whole role for under $50 a month. Totals use the plan and billing shown next to each price, so check whether a plan is billed monthly or annually before you buy.

Solo Founder — $45/mo

Ship a product and run the busywork

Lovable build the app	$25	Oct 19, 2026
Claude write, plan and code help (Pro, monthly)	$20	Oct 18, 2026
Make automations on the Free plan	Free	Oct 18, 2026
Perplexity research on the Free plan	Free	Oct 18, 2026

Marketer — $45/mo

Write, design and publish every week

Claude long-form drafts (Pro, monthly)	$20	Oct 18, 2026
Gamma decks and one-pagers (Plus, billed annually)	$9	Oct 18, 2026
Descript edit video by text (Hobbyist, billed annually)	$16	Oct 18, 2026
CapCut short-form edits on the Free plan	Free	Oct 18, 2026

Developer — $30/mo

Code faster with agents you control

Claude Code terminal agent via Claude Pro (monthly)	$20	Oct 18, 2026
GitHub Copilot in-editor completions (Pro)	$10	Oct 20, 2026
n8n self-hosted workflows	Free	Oct 20, 2026
Aider open-source pair programmer, bring your own key	Free	Oct 20, 2026

Creator — $31/mo

Video, voice and music for content

Runway generative video (Standard, monthly)	$15	Oct 18, 2026
ElevenLabs voiceover (Starter)	$6	Oct 19, 2026
Suno music with commercial rights (Pro, monthly)	$10	Oct 18, 2026
CapCut final cut on the Free plan	Free	Oct 18, 2026

First-hour quickstarts

Get a real result in your first session

One setup tip per top pick. Do this first and you'll get something useful before the free trial runs out.

Lovable · Vibe-code an app or landing page

Write a one-paragraph spec (pages, users, data) before your first prompt, and connect GitHub early so you own the code.

Cursor · AI coding assistant

Add a project rules file describing your stack and conventions; it keeps every agent edit on-style.

n8n · Set up or run AI agents

Start from a community template, then swap in your credentials. Self-host with Docker if you want unlimited runs.

Make · Automate workflows

Build the scenario with 'Run once' and sample data first, then turn on scheduling. Watch your credit count.

Scenario · Make game art and sprites

Train a custom model on 10-20 of your own reference images so every asset stays in one consistent style.

Suno · Generate music and SFX

Put genre, tempo and mood in the style box and keep lyrics separate. Free tier is non-commercial, so upgrade before you ship.

Runway · Edit and generate video

Lock a strong still image first, then animate it; image-to-video gives far more control than text alone.

Claude · Write content

Create a Project with your style guide and examples attached so every draft starts with your context.

Perplexity · Research

Use Spaces to save sources and instructions per topic, and always click through to verify key citations.

ElevenLabs · Voice and TTS

Clone your voice from a clean 1-2 minute recording in a quiet room; audio quality matters more than length.

The Skip List

Tools we'd skip right now, and why

These aren't bad tools. They're ones we can't recommend to a busy builder today, mostly because we couldn't confirm what they cost. When that changes, they come off the list and you'll hear about it in the brief.

SKIP FOR NOW	WHY	USE INSTEAD
Tabnine AI coding assistant	Sales-only pricing; no self-serve plan we can verify.	Cursor
Gemini agent (Google Cloud) Set up or run AI agents	Sales-only pricing; no self-serve plan we can verify.	n8n
Roboflow Agent Set up or run AI agents	Beta or early access; pricing isn't final yet.	n8n
CopilotKit CLiF Set up or run AI agents	Beta or early access; pricing isn't final yet.	n8n
BAND Set up or run AI agents	No public price we could verify.	n8n
Snyk Evo Set up or run AI agents	Sales-only pricing; no self-serve plan we can verify.	n8n

Stay current in 5 minutes a day

Prices and free tiers change every week. This kit is the October 2026 edition, and subscribers get each new edition automatically.

- **The weekday brief:** what launched, what changed, and what's worth trying today. Five minutes, Monday to Friday.
- **Price-change alerts:** when a tool in this kit changes its price or free tier, you hear it in the brief first.
- **Full directory:** every job, every tool, with alternatives and last-checked dates at www.usethissi.com.

Know a tool that belongs here, or spot a wrong price? Reply to any brief or email info@usethissi.com. We fix wrong prices within 24 hours.

Share the free kit: www.usethissi.com